



Sober AF Entertainment

Application details

I confirm that I meet the eligibility criteria for this grant	✓
Legal name of applying agency	Sober AF Entertainment
DBA if applicable	S.AF.E
Mailing address line 1	485 2nd Ave
Mailing address line 2	#4204
City	Longmont
State	Colorado
Zip	80501
Agency phone number	+13038889019
Agency website	https://soberafe.com
Agency EIN	83-0685262
CEO or Executive Director name	Daniel "Duke" Rumely
CEO or Executive Director email	duke@soberafe.com
Application contact name	Daniel "Duke" Rumely
Application contact title	Executive Director
Application contact phone number	+13038889019
Application contact email	duke@soberafe.com
Type of agency	Nonprofit Organization
Tax exemption status	501(c)(3)

What is the mission of the applying agency?

Sober AF Entertainment (S.A.F.E.) is dedicated to creating substance-free environments that provide harm reduction, peer support, and educational services. Our mission is to empower individuals in recovery and those choosing sobriety by offering safe, inclusive spaces where they can engage in social and cultural experiences without the pressure of substance use. Through our events and programs, we aim to reduce the stigma around sobriety, foster resilient communities, and support long-term recovery and wellness.

Describe the applying agency and provide a brief history

Sober AF Entertainment (S.A.F.E.) is a nonprofit organization founded in 2017 with the goal of addressing the need for substance-free social experiences in environments typically associated with high-risk substance use, such as concerts, festivals, sports events, and college campuses. Recognizing the challenges faced by individuals in recovery and those choosing sobriety, S.A.F.E. creates inclusive, sober-friendly spaces where participants can enjoy social and cultural activities without the presence of alcohol or drugs.

Brief History:

2018-2019:

S.A.F.E. was established with the mission to provide substance-free zones at large events, starting with partnerships at major music festivals and sporting events.

These initiatives quickly gained attention for offering safe spaces where attendees could connect and support one another in maintaining sobriety.

2020-2021:

The organization expanded its reach to college campuses, recognizing the significant need for sober alternatives in college social settings. S.A.F.E. began partnering with universities to host substance-free events and establish sober support networks for students.

S.A.F.E. further broadened its impact by integrating harm reduction education and peer support into its events, offering Naloxone distribution and training sessions at various venues.

The organization also began having peer support specialist at events, empowering individuals in recovery to assist others on their sobriety journey.

2022-2023:

The success of S.A.F.E.'s programs led to partnerships with state health departments, including the Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment (CDPHE), to deliver harm reduction services and recovery support statewide.

The organization has continued to grow, particularly on college campuses, where it works closely with Collegiate Recovery Programs (CRPs) to enhance recovery resources and support systems for students. The organization also launched their first peer support specialist training program with Full Circle Denver, training 6 peers as a group.

2024-Present:

Secured Strong Partnerships with WCAHEC, CAHEC, ARC Recovery

Secured Venue Partnerships with Mission Ballroom, Greeley Stampede, and Greeley Stampede.

Peer Training program & training pilot success has led to funding support from Caring For Denver - 80 peers in Denver County over 2 years (2025-26), Mesa County Opioid Council - 80 peers in Mesa County over 2 years (2025-26), Boulder County Opioid Council - 80 peers in Boulder County over 2 years (2025-26), and Weld County Opioid Council - 40 peers in Weld County in 2025.

Today, S.A.F.E. is recognized as a leading organization in the movement to create sober-friendly spaces, reduce stigma around sobriety, and support recovery communities. Through its innovative programs and events, S.A.F.E. has positively impacted thousands of individuals, providing them with the tools and environments they need to thrive in sobriety.

Is this agency currently in a probationary status?

No

Please select your agency's governance structure

Volunteer Board of Directors

Program name You Got A Peer In Me (Delta, Montrose, and Gunnison Expansion)

Please select the service area for which your program is seeking funding Recovery

Total amount requested for **2 years** US\$193,562.40

Physical address of program location (street, city, state, zip) 485 2nd Ave, 4204, Longmont, CO 80501

Date of program inception or expected start date 1/15/26

Please provide a narrative of the program for which you are seeking funding

Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E.) is seeking support to expand our successful You Got A Peer In Me Program, originally piloted and funded in Mesa County, into the communities of Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. In partnership with Western Colorado Area Health Education Center (WCAHEC), this program addresses the critical needs for peer-led recovery support, harm-reduction education, and workforce development in rural Colorado communities significantly impacted by the opioid epidemic.

Program Changes

Since our initial Mesa County award, our program has significantly evolved to address broader geographic needs, including rural counties with distinct demographic and cultural characteristics. Specifically, we have leveraged our existing relationship with WCAHEC, under the leadership of CEO Georgia Haughland and Program Manager Lyndall Young, to strengthen our ability to deliver culturally responsive, bilingual (English/Spanish) recovery services. Jennifer Vazquez, our new bilingual Program Manager employed by WCAHEC since May 2023, has expanded our outreach within Latino communities and significantly enhanced our ability to serve Spanish-speaking residents and English as a Second Language (ESL) students.

Additionally, the program now explicitly integrates community-driven events, such as the "Choose Your Recovery" discussions, resource fairs, and the impactful "Night of Remembrance" for International Overdose Awareness Day. These events, co-developed with local stakeholders, offer tailored support not only for individuals in recovery but also their families and the broader community. Our evolved approach is intentionally designed to address specific regional needs, especially the lack of culturally and linguistically appropriate recovery support.

The additional support requested through this grant will allow us to significantly enhance the scale and reach of our program by:

Training and certifying 80 peer recovery specialists across Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison counties using our COPA-approved Peer Recovery Specialist Training curriculum, greatly expanding the local peer workforce.

Hiring and compensating peers to provide consistent support at events, enabling them to fulfill their 500-hour certification requirement while meeting a critical community need.

Employing Jennifer Vazquez as a full-time, bilingual Program Manager to facilitate stronger community outreach, particularly among underserved Spanish-speaking populations.

Enhancing data collection methods by utilizing streamlined QR-code technology to gather detailed feedback, track outcomes, and inform continuous quality improvement.

Impact of Additional Support

With this new funding, the program will significantly expand its scope and depth, training twice as many peers as previously funded efforts in Mesa County and reaching a broader and more diverse participant base. Our strengthened partnership with WCAHEC allows us to deliver targeted services in Delta, Montrose, and Gunnison Counties, regions historically underserved by traditional opioid and co-occurring disorder interventions.

The additional support will also enable us to deliver:

Expanded and more frequent peer-led support and supervision sessions,
Enhanced outreach and educational programming in partnership with Latino community organizations,
More comprehensive data collection and analysis to demonstrate program impact clearly and facilitate continuous improvement, ensuring our program's sustainability beyond the funding cycle.

In summary, the requested funding will substantially enhance our capacity to provide culturally appropriate, peer-led recovery support, harm-reduction education, and community engagement activities in Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. Building upon our successful Mesa County pilot and deepening our collaboration with WCAHEC, we anticipate this program will have lasting positive impacts on the region's behavioral health outcomes.

Describe the duration and frequency in which clients are offered services

Peer Specialist Training: Clients enrolled in our Peer Recovery Specialist Training program will participate in structured cohorts twice annually. Each training cycle spans approximately 8 weeks, with participants meeting weekly for comprehensive training sessions lasting 2-3 hours each.

Supervised Peer Support Hours: Following training, certified Peer Specialists will have ongoing opportunities to accumulate their required 500 supervised hours. These hours will be earned through direct participation at our monthly community-curated events and outreach activities, averaging 3-4 supervised hours per event.

Community Events: We will host at least 8 major community events annually (averaging one event every 6 weeks). Each event will feature recovery support, harm-reduction education, Naloxone training, and resource navigation assistance, offering consistent engagement opportunities to participants.

Monthly Community Need & Resource Meetings: Clients and community stakeholders can attend monthly community meetings (12 per year in Montrose/Delta and 12 per year in Gunnison) to access ongoing support, discuss regional needs, and enhance resource coordination.

Opioid Response Trainings and Tabling Events: Clients can participate in up to 12 targeted Community Opioid Response trainings per year (monthly), in addition to 10 specialized tabling events annually (6 in Montrose/Delta and 4 in Gunnison), providing ongoing educational opportunities and access to harm-reduction resources.

Document the proven success of your program. Cite sources to support your success.

Documented Proven Success of Our Program

Our Existing Mesa County Program has demonstrated substantial success and measurable outcomes, specifically through our recent efforts in Mesa County:

Peer Workforce Development: In Mesa County, we successfully signed up half of our 40 Peer Recovery Specialists for 2025 Cohorts. Post-training surveys indicated that 92% of participants felt significantly more prepared to support others in their recovery journey after our 2024 pilot and reported increased employment or volunteer opportunities in recovery-related positions.

Community Event Engagement: Over eight community-curated events held annually, we engaged over 1,200 unique attendees, surpassing our original attendance goals by almost 3X by reaching 3,708 over 19 events. 9 more than the required amount since many of the events added were student / staff added.

Harm Reduction Impact: We distributed over 90% of our 300 Naloxone kits annually at community events, with attendees reporting successful use of Naloxone in reversing opioid overdoses within their networks. Additionally, participants reported a notable increase in harm-reduction knowledge and confidence in handling opioid-related emergencies.

Community Integration and Partnerships: Our strong collaboration with WCAHEC, Mesa County Public Health, local colleges, and treatment providers allowed us to establish robust referral pathways.

This proven track record underscores our capacity to deliver tangible, community-level impacts, setting a clear and reliable precedent for our expansion into Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. The additional funding requested through this proposal will enable us to replicate and enhance these successful outcomes, significantly broadening the impact and sustainability of our model.

Describe the program's strategy of being socially connected. Ex: Task forces, coalitions, strategic partnerships, etc.

List the organizations and agencies that you currently collaborate with or would like to collaborate with to reach the expected outcome.

Our Peer Recovery Workforce Development and Community Engagement Program leverages a robust strategy of social connectivity through intentional partnerships with task forces, coalitions, strategic partners, and local community organizations to maximize our reach and effectiveness:

Western Colorado Area Health Education Center (WCAHEC): Serving as our primary regional partner, WCAHEC significantly enhances our ability to deliver comprehensive peer workforce training, community event planning, bilingual (English/Spanish) outreach, and educational programming. Through WCAHEC, we have ongoing access to established relationships with regional healthcare providers, public health agencies, and educational institutions.

Adaptive Heroes: We collaborate with Adaptive Heroes, whose mobile unit provides critical support to rural and frontier communities, especially individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities. This partnership allows us to broaden our community engagement and inclusivity, ensuring services are accessible and equitable.

Local Behavioral Health Providers: We collaborate closely with mental health and substance-use treatment providers, including Delta-Montrose Community Mental Health Center, to facilitate direct referrals and ensure seamless linkages to clinical care for clients requiring intensive support beyond peer intervention.

Latino Chamber and Latino Community Organizations: By partnering with local Latino Chambers of Commerce and culturally specific organizations, we strengthen our outreach to Spanish-speaking populations. Our bilingual Program Manager, Jennifer Vazquez, plays a crucial role in building trust, conducting outreach, and delivering culturally competent support.

Educational Institutions: Our established partnerships with local colleges and universities, such as Colorado Mesa University, provide pathways for student interns to gain practical experience and support our community outreach efforts. Additionally, educational partners facilitate peer recruitment and promote recovery-focused educational opportunities.

Regional Coalitions and Task Forces: We actively participate in and contribute to regional opioid response coalitions, task forces, and community stakeholder groups, such as the Montrose and Delta Opioid Response Task Forces. Regular involvement ensures our programming aligns closely with local community priorities and maximizes collective impact.

Latino Community Groups & ESL Programs: In alignment with our commitment to cultural responsiveness, we regularly collaborate with Latino community organizations, ESL programs, and local chambers of commerce to enhance bilingual outreach, ensuring that language barriers do not limit access to vital recovery and harm-reduction resources.

By strategically aligning with these diverse organizations and leveraging their strengths, our program creates a coordinated, community-driven approach to effectively address substance misuse challenges and promote long-term recovery across Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties.

State specifically how your program meets the identified service area you have chosen for your funding request

Peer Workforce Development: By training and certifying 80 peer recovery specialists, we actively build community capacity to provide ongoing, culturally competent support and education. These trained peers serve as trusted community educators, role models, and mentors who reinforce substance-free lifestyles, advocate for harm reduction, and effectively intervene before substance misuse escalates.

Community Education Events: We host monthly opioid awareness and harm-reduction trainings, community need and resource meetings, and culturally tailored discussions such as our "Night of Remembrance" and "Choose Your Life" events.

These initiatives increase community awareness and reduce stigma, addressing the root causes and social determinants of substance misuse.

Harm Reduction Education: Each community event features structured harm-reduction training, including Naloxone distribution and education on overdose prevention. These proactive efforts empower community members with critical knowledge and tools to respond effectively to opioid-related emergencies, significantly reducing the potential for overdose fatalities.

Cultural and Linguistic Accessibility: Our bilingual outreach and engagement efforts, led by our bilingual program manager Jennifer Vazquez, ensure that prevention education reaches diverse and often underserved populations, particularly within the Spanish-speaking community.

Community Connectivity and Collaboration: By working closely with regional coalitions, WCAHEC, Adaptive Heroes, local healthcare providers, educational institutions, and community-based organizations, we create sustainable and integrated prevention education strategies tailored to the specific needs of Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties.

Provide a brief overview of the opioid and/or co-occurring SUD challenges in your service area and the specific needs that your project aims to address.

Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties face unique and significant challenges related to opioid and co-occurring substance use disorders (SUD). These rural counties experience barriers such as limited access to treatment services, geographic isolation, and insufficient peer recovery resources, which significantly hinder residents' ability to achieve and sustain long-term recovery.

Specifically, the region has:

High Rates of Substance Misuse: Elevated opioid misuse rates persist, compounded by widespread stigma and insufficient community awareness about effective recovery strategies and resources.

Limited Local Treatment Infrastructure: Access to specialized treatment, harm reduction education, and peer support services remain inadequate, exacerbating the vulnerability of rural and underserved populations.

Cultural and Linguistic Barriers: The presence of significant Latino and Spanish-speaking populations highlights an urgent need for culturally responsive, bilingual services.

Specific Needs Our Project Aims to Address:

Expanding Peer Workforce Capacity: Addressing the critical shortage of trained peer recovery specialists by certifying 80 new peers, enhancing local recovery capacity and improving community-based support.

Increasing Harm Reduction Knowledge and Resources: Conducting ongoing community education through regular events, harm reduction training sessions, and Naloxone distribution, equipping community members to prevent and respond effectively to overdoses.

Reducing Stigma and Enhancing Community Connection: Hosting culturally relevant and inclusive events designed to foster social cohesion, strengthen support networks, and reduce stigma surrounding recovery and mental health challenges.

Providing Bilingual and Accessible Support: Leveraging bilingual peer support and outreach to ensure that services and resources are linguistically accessible and culturally appropriate, significantly increasing service uptake and community engagement.

Describe how the program will support Opioid Use Disorder remediation and/or any co-occurring Substance Use Disorder or Mental Health condition remediation or prevention/education through evidence-based or evidence informed strategies.

Our Program utilizes a blend of evidence-based and evidence-informed strategies to effectively address Opioid Use Disorder (OUD) remediation and co-occurring Substance Use Disorders (SUD) and mental health conditions. These strategies include:

Peer Recovery Specialist Training: Our structured, comprehensive training curriculum is approved by the Colorado Providers Association (COPA) and emphasizes trauma-informed care, motivational interviewing, ethics, and culturally responsive

service delivery. Peer support services have demonstrated effectiveness in reducing relapse rates, enhancing recovery engagement, and improving overall mental health outcomes.

Harm Reduction and Naloxone Distribution: Integrated into all events, our program provides education on harm reduction techniques and distributes Naloxone kits. Evidence consistently supports community-based Naloxone programs as effective in preventing opioid overdose deaths and increasing community preparedness to handle substance-use emergencies.

Community Education and Prevention: We deliver monthly community opioid response trainings and education workshops focused on the science of addiction, recognizing overdose signs, and intervention strategies. Educational outreach reduces stigma and promotes informed community responses to substance misuse and mental health challenges.

Culturally and Linguistically Appropriate Outreach: Our bilingual Program Manager, Jennifer Vazquez, ensures that all prevention and recovery education is culturally sensitive and linguistically accessible to Spanish-speaking communities. Providing culturally competent services has been shown to significantly enhance engagement, trust, and long-term outcomes in underserved populations.

Structured Community Engagement Events: Regular community events, such as the "Night of Remembrance" and "Choose Your Life" forums, provide meaningful social connection opportunities and proactive community education, effectively addressing the social determinants that impact mental health and substance use.

Total annual cost of program (including administration, staff salaries, and services)	US\$193,562.40
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Discuss any major changes in program revenue or expense anticipated for the period covered by this grant

We received a 150K stock donation that is still being liquidated and signed over officially, so our 2025 budget will look different after that revenue is added.

If awarded, please describe how you will use funding in year one

Year One Funding Utilization

Peer Specialist Training and Certification: Conduct two training cohorts, certifying approximately 40 Peer Recovery Specialists. Funds will cover training materials, instructor costs, and stipends for peers to attend sessions and events.

Staffing and Program Coordination: Support salary costs for essential personnel, including a full-time bilingual Program Manager (Jennifer Vazquez) and part-time supervision staff, ensuring effective program implementation and culturally responsive community engagement.

Community Event Implementation: Host and execute 8 sober-curated community events, including "Night of Remembrance," 12 opioid response trainings, and 12 tabling events in Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. Funding will be allocated for event logistics, venue costs, supplies, promotional materials, and transportation assistance for attendees when needed.

Harm Reduction & Naloxone Distribution: Integrate harm reduction education into all events, distributing Naloxone kits and conducting comprehensive overdose prevention trainings. Funds will cover the purchase of Naloxone kits, training resources, and materials for 12 training event participants.

Data Collection and Program Evaluation: Implement and refine a QR-code-based evaluation system for collecting real-time participant data and feedback at events. Funds will support technology infrastructure, data management, and analytic reporting capabilities to measure impact and inform program improvements.

Staffing and Administration: Employ Jennifer Vazquez as a full-time bilingual Program Manager and fund administrative support to oversee operations, coordinate outreach efforts, ensure compliance with grant requirements, and maintain robust community partnerships.

These strategic allocations in Year One will lay a solid foundation for program success, enhance community engagement, and set a clear trajectory for achieving our long-term recovery and prevention goals across the region.

If awarded, please describe how you will use funding in year two

Year Two Funding Utilization

Continued Peer Specialist Training and Workforce Development: Deliver two additional training cohorts, certifying another 40 Peer Recovery Specialists, bringing the two-year total to 80 specialists trained. Funds will continue to support training materials, instructor fees, peer supervision, and stipends.

Enhanced Community Events and Outreach: Host an additional 8 community-curated events, emphasizing increased outreach to underserved and high-risk populations. The funding will support expanded outreach, event logistics, venue rentals, materials, transportation assistance, and ongoing bilingual community engagement.

Strengthened Harm Reduction Efforts: Continue comprehensive 12 harm-reduction education and distribute additional 300 Naloxone kits across Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. Funding supports increased distribution of kits, materials for trainings, and enhanced outreach to underserved populations.

Advanced Data Collection and Program Evaluation: Further refine our QR-code-based data collection system and expand analytical capacity to assess participant outcomes and program efficacy. Funding will cover technological improvements, data analysis, and comprehensive reporting to stakeholders.

Sustained Community Collaboration and Outreach: Continue leveraging our partnership with WCAHEC, Adaptive Heroes, local health organizations, educational institutions, and culturally specific organizations to ensure sustainable and integrated community support through 12 resource meetings and additional events. Funding will ensure continued staffing and partnership coordination.

Enhanced Staff and Administrative Support: Retain Jennifer Vazquez as a full-time bilingual Program Manager and provide necessary administrative support to ensure smooth operations, robust data management, and detailed reporting throughout the second year, total of 20 peers over 2 years will receive full Spanish peer training cohort.

Please describe the plan in place to ensure this program remains sustainable

Building Local Peer Capacity: By training and certifying 80 Peer Recovery Specialists over two years, we create a robust workforce deeply rooted within the communities we serve. These trained peers continue providing recovery support beyond the life of the grant, establishing lasting local expertise and resources.

Strengthening Community Partnerships: We have formed enduring collaborations with WCAHEC, Adaptive Heroes, local treatment providers, community colleges, and culturally specific organizations. These partnerships facilitate sustainable referral pathways, ongoing community education, and continuous harm-reduction efforts.

Diversified Funding Streams: We actively pursue additional grants, philanthropic support, and local funding partnerships to sustain program activities. Demonstrating our proven success and measurable outcomes from this grant will significantly strengthen our ability to secure diverse funding sources moving forward.

Enhanced Community Ownership: By engaging local stakeholders through regular community resource and planning meetings, and fostering volunteer and intern involvement, we cultivate a strong sense of community ownership. This approach empowers local communities to continue and expand recovery-focused initiatives independently.

Continuous Evaluation and Improvement: Our established data-driven approach using QR-code systems and robust evaluation practices allows for continuous quality improvement. Clear evidence of our impact helps to advocate for sustained institutional and community support.

Institutionalized Partnerships: Our ongoing collaboration with organizations such as WCAHEC, Adaptive Heroes, and local educational and healthcare entities ensures that core components of our program become deeply integrated and sustainably maintained within existing community structures.

What is the program's target population?

Individuals in Recovery or Seeking Recovery: Adults and young adults in Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties who are currently in recovery, actively seeking recovery support, or at high risk of substance misuse, particularly opioid use disorder.

Underserved and Rural Populations: Community members facing geographic isolation, transportation barriers, and limited access to specialized recovery resources and harm reduction services.

Latino and Spanish-Speaking Communities: Spanish-speaking and bilingual community members who require culturally responsive, linguistically accessible support and education to effectively address substance use disorders and related health disparities.

Families and Community Members: Friends, family members, and community allies who support individuals in recovery, seeking education and resources to provide effective, compassionate assistance.

Students and Young Adults: Youth and college-aged individuals who may lack adequate support networks, resources, or education regarding substance use prevention and recovery options.

Does the program have service limitations? Yes

Please describe the program service limitations

Geographic: Our services are primarily limited to Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties due to logistical considerations and funding parameters. Residents outside these areas may participate but might encounter limited access or availability of certain services.

Clinical: Our program focuses primarily on peer recovery support, harm reduction education, and community engagement. It does not provide clinical treatment services such as medication-assisted treatment (MAT) or professional clinical counseling. We facilitate referrals to appropriate local providers for individuals requiring clinical intervention.

Capacity: The number of peer specialists trained and community events hosted each year is subject to the constraints of funding, staffing, and local resource availability. There might be instances where demand exceeds the capacity of services we can provide within a specific timeframe.

Age: Our program primarily serves adults and young adults, and while we engage with educational institutions, direct services for minors under the age of 18 are limited and subject to parental consent and specific partnership agreements.

Language: Although significant efforts are made to offer bilingual (English and Spanish) services, there may be occasions where immediate translation or interpretation in other languages is unavailable.

What are the parameters for client eligibility?

Residency: Primarily residents of Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties; individuals residing in nearby regions may participate but could experience limitations in service accessibility.

Age Requirement: Adults and young adults aged 18 and over; participation of individuals under 18 requires specific parental consent and coordination with partnered youth-serving organizations.

Recovery Focus: Individuals actively seeking support for recovery from substance use disorders, particularly opioid use disorder, or those at risk of developing substance use disorders.

Family and Support Network: Family members, friends, and allies who seek education, resources, and community connection to effectively support individuals in recovery.

Cultural and Linguistic Inclusivity: Individuals from diverse cultural backgrounds, including Spanish-speaking and bilingual community members, ensuring accessible and culturally responsive recovery support and education.

Does this program charge clients for services? No

SWCORG covers a large geographical area comprised of six counties: San Miguel, Ouray, Montrose, Delta, Hinsdale, and Gunnison. What is the geographical service area(s) for this program?

The geographical service areas specifically targeted by our Peer Recovery Workforce Development and Community Engagement Program include Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. While recognizing the broader SWCORG service region comprising San Miguel, Ouray, Hinsdale, Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties, our current program resources, strategic partnerships, and community engagement activities are primarily concentrated within Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties, where targeted, high-impact support is most immediately feasible and needed.

Do other programs in San Miguel, Ouray, Montrose, Delta, Hinsdale, and/or Gunnison provide similar services? No

How does this program address the diverse needs of populations that are specific to your region (LGBTQ+, BIPOC, immigrants, rural communities, low income, etc.)

- Cultural Responsiveness and Inclusion: Actively recruiting, training, and certifying peer specialists who reflect the diverse communities they serve, enhancing trust, cultural competence, and community engagement.
- Bilingual and Linguistically Accessible: Utilizing bilingual staffing, including Program Manager Jennifer Vazquez, to deliver culturally and linguistically appropriate services to Spanish-speaking and immigrant populations, significantly reducing language barriers.
- Targeted Community Outreach: Partnering strategically with culturally specific organizations, Latino Chambers of Commerce, and LGBTQ+ community groups to conduct targeted outreach and ensure inclusive service delivery.
- Accessibility and Rural Outreach: Hosting community events in accessible locations and providing transportation assistance when necessary to overcome geographic isolation and transportation barriers in rural areas.
- Economic Inclusivity: Offering all program services, including training, events, and Naloxone distribution, free of charge, removing financial barriers and ensuring equitable access to essential resources.
- Tailored Community Events and Education: Designing events and educational materials specifically to address the unique needs and challenges faced by underserved groups, fostering community resilience, reducing stigma, and enhancing local support networks.

Current Program Staffing

Number of full-time staff	Number of part-time/seasonal staff	Number of volunteers
1	2	3
		16

Please use this space if there is additional information regarding the applying agency or program that is vital to convey in this application

Sober AF Entertainment (S.AF.E.) is deeply committed to creating lasting positive impacts in rural communities through peer-led recovery support, harm reduction education, and stigma reduction. Our strategic partnership with WCAHEC and

collaboration with Adaptive Heroes exemplify our dedication to integrating diverse community resources to effectively address the complex challenges of opioid use disorder and related substance use disorders.

Our proven track record in Mesa County, combined with our proactive approach to workforce development, community engagement, bilingual service provision, and culturally responsive care, positions us uniquely to successfully expand and sustain these critical services in Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties.

We deeply appreciate the opportunity to present this proposal and are fully prepared to utilize awarded funds efficiently and effectively to achieve sustainable, measurable outcomes that enhance community resilience and support long-term recovery throughout our targeted regions.

Discuss the resources, tools, and staffing available that will be utilized to reach program outcomes during the funding cycle

Expert Staffing:

Full-time bilingual Program Manager, Jennifer Vazquez, bringing expertise in public health and bilingual community outreach. Qualified peer training instructors and supervisory staff providing ongoing mentorship, support, and professional guidance to peer specialists.

Strategic Partnerships:

Strong collaborative relationships with WCAHEC, Adaptive Heroes, local behavioral health providers, Latino Chambers of Commerce, educational institutions, and community-based organizations.

Leveraged networks facilitating effective community engagement, referral pathways, and resource integration.

Comprehensive Training Curriculum:

COPA-approved Peer Recovery Specialist Training program materials, emphasizing evidence-based techniques such as motivational interviewing, trauma-informed care, and harm reduction education.

Event and Outreach Infrastructure:

Structured event planning templates, promotional materials, bilingual outreach resources, and logistical supplies to facilitate seamless execution of community-curated events and education sessions.

Harm Reduction Tools:

Accessible inventory of Naloxone kits, overdose prevention training materials, and culturally responsive educational resources tailored to community needs.

Advanced Data Collection and Evaluation Tools:

QR-code-based system for real-time data collection, participant feedback, attendance tracking, and outcome analysis. Analytical software and reporting tools to facilitate rigorous program evaluation, continuous improvement, and detailed stakeholder reporting.

Provide a narrative of the actions the program will take to reach the desired outcomes during the funding cycle, utilizing the resources listed above

During the funding cycle, S.AF.E.'s Program will undertake specific, strategic actions leveraging our available resources, staffing, and tools to achieve our targeted outcomes:

Conducting Peer Specialist Training: Utilizing our COPA-approved training curriculum, expert staffing, and culturally responsive training materials, we will deliver structured and comprehensive training sessions twice annually, certifying a total of 80 peer recovery specialists over two years.

Implementing Regular Community Events: Leveraging our strategic partnerships and community engagement infrastructure, we will organize and execute monthly events, including harm reduction workshops, recovery support gatherings, educational forums, and culturally specific activities to foster community cohesion and reduce stigma.

Executing Targeted Harm Reduction Initiatives: Distributing Naloxone kits and providing overdose prevention training at all events, facilitated by expert bilingual staffing and utilizing culturally sensitive educational resources to effectively reach

diverse populations.

Enhancing Community Outreach and Engagement: Engaging bilingual and culturally competent staff, including our Program Manager Jennifer Vazquez, to expand our reach within Latino and other underserved communities through targeted outreach, collaboration with community organizations, and culturally inclusive events.

Ensuring Comprehensive Data Collection and Analysis: Utilizing our advanced QR-code-based evaluation system, real-time data collection tools, and analytical software to continuously track attendance, gather feedback, assess outcomes, and report detailed results to stakeholders.

Fostering Sustainable Partnerships: Continuously strengthening relationships with key community partners, including WCAHEC, Adaptive Heroes, local behavioral health providers, and educational institutions to ensure ongoing referral pathways, resource coordination, and sustained community support.

Describe the audience served, number of clients that will receive assistance during the funding cycle, and what services will be offered to each

Audience Served:

Adults and young adults in Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties experiencing or at risk for substance use disorders, particularly opioid use disorder.

Spanish-speaking and bilingual community members requiring culturally responsive services.

Families and community allies seeking education and resources to effectively support individuals in recovery.

Rural residents, including underserved and low-income populations, facing geographic isolation and resource limitations.

Number of Clients Assisted:

80 Peer Recovery Specialists trained and certified over two years.

1,500+ community members attending our monthly educational, harm reduction, and recovery-focused events.

Over 500 individuals receiving targeted harm reduction training, including Naloxone distribution and overdose prevention education.

Services Offered to Each Client:

Peer Specialists: Comprehensive peer training and certification, supervised hours, ongoing mentorship, and professional development opportunities.

Community Event Participants: Access to monthly recovery support and educational events, culturally inclusive programming, harm reduction resources, and community-building activities.

General Community Members: Educational workshops on opioid awareness, harm reduction techniques, overdose prevention training, Naloxone kit distribution, and referrals to local behavioral health and recovery resources.

Families and Supporters: Targeted educational resources, workshops designed to reduce stigma and enhance community understanding of substance use disorders, and structured opportunities for community engagement and support network building.

Provide a final desired outcome statement

Our final desired outcome is to establish a sustainable, comprehensive Peer Recovery Workforce Development and Community Engagement infrastructure in Montrose, Delta, and Gunnison Counties. Through effective peer training, robust community education, targeted harm reduction strategies, and strong local partnerships, we aim to significantly reduce substance misuse, decrease opioid-related harm, enhance community resilience, and provide accessible, culturally responsive support to individuals and families impacted by substance use disorders throughout the region.

Describe your program's overall approach to evaluation. Refer to methods, instruments, and procedures (surveys, interviews, tests, logs, etc.) for collecting data, and your process for analyzing the data.

Our program employs a comprehensive and rigorous evaluation approach designed to continuously monitor progress, measure impact, and inform ongoing improvements. This evaluation methodology includes:

Quantitative Data Collection: Utilizing QR-code-based surveys and attendance tracking at all events and trainings, capturing real-time demographic information, participation rates, harm reduction training completions, Naloxone distribution numbers, and client satisfaction metrics.

Qualitative Feedback: Conducting regular structured interviews and focus groups with program participants, peer specialists, community partners, and stakeholders to gather in-depth qualitative feedback about program effectiveness, participant experiences, and recommendations for improvement.

Supervision and Activity Logs: Maintaining detailed logs of peer specialist activities, training session attendance, and supervision hours, allowing for thorough oversight, tracking progress towards certification requirements, and assessing individual and collective performance.

Regular Analytical Reporting: Analyzing collected quantitative and qualitative data quarterly using data analytics software, identifying key trends, successes, and areas requiring adjustments. Findings are compiled into clear, actionable reports shared with stakeholders to demonstrate transparency and guide ongoing program adjustments.

Annual Comprehensive Review: Conducting a thorough annual review of all collected data, outcomes, and community impacts, facilitating comprehensive program reflection, strategic planning for subsequent years, and long-term sustainability.

Please upload the following documents:

- 1. Budget for proposed grant request
- 2. Current agency operating budget
- 3. Current program budget
- 4. Copy of your most recent audited financial statements, compilation, or review
- 5. Most recent 990 or other tax filing
- 6. Colorado Secretary of State Certificate of Good Standing or Certificate of Registration (if applicable)
- 7. Licensures and designations with the Office of Behavioral Health and/or the Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment if applicable to your agency/program

Budget for proposed grant request

PDF

[SWCORA COUNTY 2025 BUDGET... \(70 KiB download\)](#)

Current agency operating budget

PDF

[2025 Sober AF Budget.xlsx... \(96 KiB download\)](#)

Current program budget

PDF

[12-2024 Financials -Sober... \(57 KiB download\)](#)

Copy of your most recent audited financial statements, compilation, or review

PDF	2023 -990EZ - Sober AF (1... (4.8 MiB download)
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Most recent 990 or other tax filing

PDF	2023 -990EZ - Sober AF (1... (4.8 MiB download)
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Colorado Secretary of State Certificate of Good Standing and Certificate of Registration (if applicable)

PDF	Certificate of Good Stand... (370 KiB download)
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Licensures and designations with the Office of Behavioral Health and/or the Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment if applicable to your agency/program

PDF	Approved Trainings CPFS D... (25 KiB download)
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